

House Vika

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"THE TRUTH SHALL PREVAIL ABOVE ALL LIES"

Quick Facts

Status: Duke/Duchess

Origin: Aicruae (Eastern)

House Name Meaning: The Gods Chosen Warrior

Founded: 8,520 BR (4th oldest noble house in Aicruae)

Founder: Axiker Vika

Seat: Haleker, Eastern Aicruae

Faction: Divine Faction

Spirit Animal: Wild Boar

Colors: Dark Purple (Sovereignty) & Light Purple/Lavender (Bravery)

Wealth: ~ 195, 000 Rern

Military: 310,000 men (The Ivera's: 270,000 | Swords of Mertyeria: 40,000)

Religion: Rillic

Theme Song: "Team" by Lorde

Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Duke/Duchess, One of the most powerful houses in Aicruae, with military strength rivaling the royal family.

Solis's Era: Eradicated, Following Orcus's death in 7,217 BR, Emperor Solis ordered the complete destruction of House Vika. The Ivera's and the Swords of Mertyeria were disbanded and or absorbed into the imperial military. The Vika estates in Haleker were seized. Any remaining members bearing the Vika name were executed or forced to renounce their house and take new names. After 1,303 years, House Vika ceased to exist.

Crandona's Era: None.

Minara's Era: None.

Why They Matter

House Vika is the military backbone of Aicruae and one of the root causes of the civil war that tears the kingdom apart. Their power grew so vast that King Darien Lacern Patton married his son Benjamin II to Duke Rarielo's only daughter, Mihai Julie Vika, specifically to keep House Vika loyal. That marriage produced the twins Iris and Orcus, and when Benjamin took a concubine and publicly favored his illegitimate son Solis over the Vika-blooded heirs, it set in motion a civil war that ended with House Vika's total eradication.

They are the house that proves a simple truth in this world: being the strongest doesn't mean you survive. Being 310,000 soldiers strong, being feared by every other noble house, being ranked number one in all of Aicruae but none of it saved them when the political winds shifted.

Nicknames People Call Them During This Era

"The Eastern Shield"

"The Boars of Haleker"

"The Eastern Arm (as in, the military arm of Eastern Aicruae)"

"Haleker's Own"

"The Haleker Horde"

"The Purple Tide"

"The Mad House"

"The Victors of Summers" (Their founding battle. Where Axiker earned the title.)

"The Champions of Afera" (Led the coalition that destroyed House Baliva.)

"The Lords of Highwater"

"The Gods' Chosen Warriors"

"Axiker's Line"

Heraldry

Crest: A shield divided into eight triangular sections radiating from the center, alternating between deep plum purple and light lavender pink. A brown wild boar runs across the shield, low to the ground and moving on a diagonal. Its tusks are bright white, its mouth is open with a red tongue showing, and its coat is shaded in chestnut tones with darker color along the spine. The shield is framed by a wreath

of green laurel branches bearing small red berries, joined at the base by a red Tudor rose with a white center and green leaves.

Symbolism: The darker purple sections stand for sovereignty; the lighter lavender represents bravery. The boar, known for charging without hesitation, reflects House Vika's fearsome nature: if triggered, they turn feral and willing to do anything to survive. Wild boars are also commonly found in House Vika's territory around Haleker. The laurel wreath symbolizes victory, endurance and honor. The red rose represents passion and bloodline.

Motto: "The Truth Shall Prevail Above All Lies."

Power & Influence

Source of Power

Military strength, fleet power, trade influence, fear and intimidation. House Vika is generally powerful, with decent influence in every aspect of Aicruean life.

Internal Power Structure

House Vika believes the strongest should lead. To be the head of the family or hold power within the house, you need to be powerful and strong. It doesn't matter if you are a man or woman, as long as you can fight, you have power.

Military Forces

House Vika is ranked number one in Aicruae for military strength, commanding two exclusive military organizations:

The Ivera's, A mercenary force of 270,000 men, working exclusively for House Vika.

The Swords of Mertyeria, 40,000 men, also working exclusively for House Vika.

Combined: 310,000 soldiers. This force was so large it rivaled the crown's own military, which is precisely why King Darien arranged the marriage alliance.

Lands & Income

Seat: The town of Haleker in Eastern Aicruae (their Dukedom seat).

Key industries: Trade, manufacturing, and military services. Also holds a business alliance with House Leva for salt trading.

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Patton (Royal Marriage), Queen Mihai Julie Vika married King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II, tying House Vika directly to the crown. This marriage was arranged by King Darien Lacern Patton to ensure House Vika's loyalty, as their power had grown to rival the royal family's.

House Vemer (Code of Rose), Marriage alliance through Aintana Vika and Hasken Vemer.

House Leva (Business Alliance), House Vika initiated a partnership in a salt trading business owned by House Leva.

Rival Houses

House Arvento, Ongoing rivalry.

Shared Territory

House Aedria, Both houses share the town of Haleker, occupying opposite ends of the city. Both inflict "brutish punishments" on criminals. House Aedria is also a member of the Council of the Forsaken.

House Culture

Religion

Rillic. Believers of Rillic hold that they were put on this planet to fuel the gods' strength and give them a stronger tether to the physical/mortal world.

Traditions

Trial of the Name, Over the years, Vika children are put through tests to prove they are worthy of their name. If they don't participate, start to perform badly, or fail completely, they are disowned.

Poison Immunity Training, All Vika are administered poison from the ages of seven to roughly fifteen through eighteen, developing immunity against poison by gradually self-administering non-lethal amounts.

Values

Military prowess, strength-based leadership, and survival at all costs. "We protect what's ours" is the house's defining philosophy.

Reputation

Infamous among the other noble houses for being snobbish and too powerful. House Vika has an estranged relationship with other houses they've been isolated because of their history of mental illness. But at the same time, the other houses need House Vika's fleet and military, so they use them as much as possible.

Common Sayings About House Vika

"Nothing is scarier than Vika at the head of an army."

"Vika's are built for war from birth."

History

Founding (8,520 BR)

Axiker Vika, the son of a prostitute named Pokuerya, rose from nothing. His mother had killed her abusive husband and fled to a nearby town, becoming a sex worker to feed her three children. Two of Axiker's siblings died in winter. He survived, vowed to create a respectable family, and earned a noble title for his valor during the Battle of Summers, founding House Vika in 8,520 BR. His mother Pokuerya chose the house name, meaning "The Gods Chosen Warrior." She lived just long enough to see it founded before dying at 54.

Rise to Power

House Vika began as a house of noble knights loyal to the king, but after winning countless wars they gained recognition and climbed the social ladder. They formed political alliances with noble houses like Vemer and Leva to secure their position, and eventually their military power rivaled that of the royal family itself.

Major Victories

The Battle of Summers (founding battle), the Battle of Little Hill, the Battle of Bears, Bloody Winter (first recorded successful coup against the royal family of Aicruae), the Siege of High Water, and the Battle of Rivers Point.

Notable Creations

Joyless Death, A poison made from Nerai, a toxic yellow plant. Created by Yarsi Vika to take her own life rather than be married to an abusive cousin. Designed to put its victims to death calmly.

"So the Warrior Goes Marching On", House Vika's battle song, composed by Jeneo Vika on the battlefield after learning of his wife Pataryi's death. Played at the start and end of every battle.

Major Disgraces

The house's history of mental illness has caused isolation from other houses. Notable disgraces include Axiker Vika's "Sunset Hour" (persecuting those with mental illness and disabilities, before suffering mental decline himself), Ceva the Mad stabbing her brother at a family dinner, the truth behind the Siege of High Water (Vono hiding while a female soldier named Ashara won the battle), and the cruel treatment of Yarsi Vika's body after her suicide.

Eradication (7,217 BR)

After Orcus's death, Emperor Solis Elias Patton ordered the complete eradication of House Vika. Before the war, House Vika had been "too militarized to eliminate and too intermarried with the royal line to ostracize" but the twins' coup and civil war sealed their fate. The Ivera's and the Swords of Mertyeria were disbanded or absorbed into the imperial military. The estates in Haleker were seized. Remaining members were executed or forced to renounce the Vika name. The fourth oldest noble house in Aicruae, founded in 8,520 BR, was gone after 1,303 years.

Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's origins to its final generation.

Pokuerya Vika (8,571 BR – 8,517 BR)

"The Mother of Vika"

Name meaning: Star

Pokuerya killed her abusive husband Mihadlen Agasetire and fled to a nearby town, where she became a prostitute to support her three children: Axiker, Belia, and Dreskien. Two of her three children died in the winter following her husband's murder. Her eldest, Axiker, went on to found House Vika. Pokuerya chose the house's name, meaning "The Gods Chosen Warrior", and lived just long enough to see it established. She died at 54.

Axiker Vika (8,542 BR – 8,470 BR)

Founder of House Vika

Name meaning: He Who Is Like the Sun

The son of a prostitute, Axiker rose from nothing, vowing to create a respectable family and not repeat his father's mistakes. He earned his noble title during the Battle of Summers and founded House Vika in 8,520 BR. But the vow he made, he ultimately failed. Axiker had a zero-tolerance policy for those with mental health issues or disabilities, taking pleasure in what he called the "Sunset Hour", target practice against those who displayed such characteristics. Ironically, in his later years, he exhibited the same traits he despised: found peeing on walls, talking to himself, and deteriorating mentally. He died at 72.

Ceva Vika (8,376 BR – 8,352 BR)

"Ceva the Mad"

Name meaning: God's Origin / Proof of God

One of House Vika's most estranged members. Ceva had strange, eerie "prophetic" dreams and claimed to see the end of the world coming. At a family dinner, she stabbed her older brother Raimaeo Vika (one of her three older brothers, Raimaeo, Xavien, and Eseraen) several times in the chest. He spent several days fighting his wounds before dying. Ceva was 19. After a few more years battling her mental illness, she died at 24. She is considered a stain on House Vika and one of the key figures who cemented the reputation that all Vika have some sort of mental illness.

Jeneo Vika (8,345 BR – 8,268 BR)

"The Lord of Thousand Years"

Name meaning: Flame

Father of Sekid Vika and ancestor of Vono Vika. Known for training two successful generations of House Vika generals, Sekid's generation and young Dexona's generation. His greatest legacy is the creation of House Vika's battle song "So the Warrior Goes Marching On," composed on the battlefield after receiving news of his wife Pataryi's death during one of his campaigns. In his final days, Jeneo hummed the song every day while looking out the window. (Full song and performance details below.)

Sekid Vika (8,299 BR – 8,227 BR)

"The Great Warrior of Haleker"

Name meaning: Stranger

The greatest fighter of House Vika. He never lost a fight and was willing to get bloody for his family, he pioneered the house's defining philosophy of "we protect what's ours." But what set Sekid apart was that he didn't take pleasure in killing. He was a gentle man, perhaps too gentle for his own good. with a deep hatred of blood, which contradicted his role as a knight and warrior. He believed in honor and a divine code of conduct. Sekid won 47 battles over his 72 years, the most notable being the Battle of Rivers Point, where he invented a battle strategy called the Fox Maneuver (also known as the Great Ambush).

Dexona Vika (8,286 BR – 8,248 BR)

"The Champion of Little Hill"

Name meaning: Plant

The first female highborn general recorded in history. Before her, no noble lady had wielded a sword and guided an army. Dexona was incredibly strong-willed and earned many victories that brought honor to House Vika, including the Battle of Little Hill, the Battle of Bears, and Bloody Winter, the first recorded successful coup against the royal family of Aicruae. She died at 38 at the Battle of GreyNest, one of the only battles she ever lost. Her body was returned to her family with her hair shaved and her neck chopped nearly through. She was buried on the family's land in Haleker.

Aintana Vika (8,270 BR – 8,183 BR)

"The Jewel of House Vika" | "The Winter Rose"

Name meaning: Of a Bright Pink Hue

Aintana married Hasken Vemer, son of the great warrior Ualvo Vemer, at age 17, forming the marriage alliance known as the Code of Rose. She gave him three sons, but theirs was a one-sided love affair: she could never love him as much as he loved her. Aintana died at 87 and requested to be buried away from her husband, underneath a cherry tree.

Ooya Vika I & Ooya Vika II (8,007 BR – 7,967/7,966 BR)

The Conjoined Twins

Name meaning: (Given by their dying mother)

Two conjoined twins born to the high lady layeta Vika, who died in childbirth before she could name them both. Her last words were an attempt to name one of the twins "Ooya" so both sisters took the name in her honor. Despite being joined at the hip, both lived functional lives. They both married a man named Wasler, a lesser feudal lord, though only Ooya Vika II produced an heir a healthy baby girl. Ooya II died first in 7,967 BR. Ooya I lived with her dead conjoined twin, suffering from the illness that came with it, before dying less than a year later in 7,966 BR.

Yarsi Vika (7,882 BR – 7,863 BR)

Creator of Joyless Death

Name meaning: Joy

An alchemist who created the poison known as Joyless Death, made from Nerai, a toxic yellow plant. She designed the poison to take her own life after learning her father planned to marry her to her mentally unstable, physically violent cousin, who was twice her age and had killed his previous wife.

"I would rather die by my own hands than by that of a drunken man you all should have me call my husband."

She succeeded. Upon her death at 19, her body was not buried on family land but laid to rest in the ocean. The words "foolish daughter" were engraved on her forehead. Before her death, she had one child out of wedlock, supposedly by the

King of Aicruae, a child named Tacah, who died in infancy two months after birth. She gave birth to Tacah at 16; the supposed father would have been 25.

Vono Vika (7,496 BR – 7,429 BR)

“The Bloody Prince of the Damned Vika”

Name meaning: Fearless

Son of House Vika hero Vasernio Vika. Vono was a terrible man who had multiple wives and bastards. Behaving in similar sportsmanship as his ancestor Axiker Vika. His most notable “accomplishment” is the Siege of High Water, though the truth is that Vono didn’t win it. A female soldier named Ashara did. During the siege, Vono was hiding over three miles from the battlegrounds. He had everyone who participated on House Vika’s behalf killed except Ashara, whose tongue he ripped out so she couldn’t tell anyone the truth. He then forced her to bear five of his children, saying she was “too fierce and needed to be taught the feminine duty of being a wife and mother.” Ashara would go on to have seven more of his children, twelve total, not counting stillbirths (seventeen pregnancies altogether). She was the only one of Vono’s wives he didn’t kill and whose children lived to adulthood. Vono claimed he liked how much Ashara looked like him, saying “it was like having sexual relations with himself.” Ashara is an ancestor of Iris and Orcus, who bear a resemblance to her.

Duke Rarielo Vika (7,318 BR – 7,252 BR)

Duke of Vika | Father of the Vika Queen

Name meaning: One of Many Blessings

Father of Lemalen Vika and Queen Mihai Julie Vika. Arranged his daughter’s marriage to Prince Benjamin (later King Benjamin II) to cement the Vika-Patton alliance. His death at 66 created a power vacuum in House Vika’s leadership and removed the moderating influence that had kept the marriage alliance stable. Duke Rarielo died suspiciously, from poisoning.

Lemalen Vika (7,285 BR – 7,262 BR)

Heir to the Dukedom

Name meaning: Gift Given Unto Thee

Older brother of Mihai Julie Vika by three years. As heir apparent, he would have inherited House Vika and commanded its military forces. He died in an ambush one month before his sister's wedding at age 23, leaving Mihai as Duke Rarielo's only surviving child. His death was never solved. Some whispered it was orchestrated by those who wanted the Vika-Patton alliance to fail. His death ensured House Vika would eventually pass to the collateral line through Gaceqi.

Gaceqi Vika (7,314 BR – 7,258 BR)

Lord of House Vika

Name meaning: He Who Stands Alone

Duke Rarielo's younger brother. Father of Beazen Vika. Gaceqi predeceased his brother, which meant that when Duke Rarielo died in 7,252 BR, leadership passed to Gaceqi's son Beazen rather than to Gaceqi himself. Died at 56.

Beazen Vika (7,288 BR – 7,223 BR)

Acting Duke / Regent of House Vika

Name meaning: Ferret

Son of Gaceqi Vika. First cousin to Queen Mihai Julie Patton, first cousin once removed to Iris and Orcus. After Duke Rarielo's death in 7,252 BR, House Vika technically fell under Prince Orcus's control as the male heir through Queen Mihai's bloodline, but Beazen served as the actual administrator and head of house operations. He managed House Vika through the turbulent years of Queen Mihai's decline and growing tensions at court. His death in 7,223 BR, two years before the civil war, allowed Iris to take direct control of House Vika and its military forces. Died at 65.

Mihai Julie Vika (7,282 BR – 7,247 BR)

Queen of Aicruae | "The Vika Queen"

Name meaning: As of the Will of Allan, the Goddess of Nature

Only daughter of Duke Rarielo. Married to Prince Benjamin Lawrence Patton (later King Benjamin II) at approximately age 20 in 7,262 BR. The marriage was arranged to ensure House Vika's loyalty to the crown. She bore twin children: Iris and Orcus. When her husband took Lady Emillea Hige as his concubine and fathered a son (Solis) whom he publicly favored, Mihai was driven to madness, a

decline described as psychosis and schizophrenia precipitated by humiliation at court. She died at 35, six years before her husband and before the twins' coup.

Iris Aleka Patton (7,256 BR – 7,218 BR)

"The Damned" | "The Lady of Sorrow" | Final Head of House Vika

Name meaning: Lovely Flower

Elder twin daughter of Queen Mihai Julie and King Benjamin II. Half-Vika by blood. After Beazen's death in 7,223 BR, she took direct control of House Vika and its armies. Seductive, violent, and deeply wounded by her father's neglect, she and her twin brother Orcus staged a coup after their father's death, publicly poisoning Lady Emillea while nine-year-old Solis watched. During the civil war, she commanded the Vika forces against Solis. Killed at the Battle of Rewqo in 7,218 BR after killing fifteen men. Buried beneath a temple of Nellebrie. She was the last head of House Vika.

Orcus Emere Patton (7,256 BR – 7,217 BR)

"The Unlawful"

Name meaning: Teller of the Future

Younger twin son of Queen Mihai Julie and King Benjamin II. Half-Vika by blood. Calm, cold, and analytical, the strategist to his sister's fury. Sterile, he could produce no heirs. After losing a duel to Solis in the throne room, he stabbed himself rather than accept banishment:

| "I would rather join our sister than live in this wretched place."

Buried beside Iris at Rewqo.

Succession of House Vika

Duke Rarielo Vika, Head of House until his death in 7,252 BR.

Beazen Vika, Acting head from 7,252 BR to 7,223 BR, under Orcus's nominal control.

Princess Iris Aleka Patton, Direct control from 7,223 BR until her death in 7,218 BR.

House Vika was eradicated by order of Emperor Solis in 7,217 BR. No succession followed.

"So the Warrior Goes Marching On"

Composed by Jeneo Vika on the battlefield after learning of his wife Pataryi's death. Played at the start and end of every House Vika battle.

Verse 1:

She fell while I was far from home,
No hand of mine to hold.
The gods gave word, the gods gave none
So the warrior goes marching on.

Chorus:

March on, march on, the sun still burns,
March on, march on, till I return.
For her bones lie cold and her voice is gone
So the warrior goes marching on.

Verse 2:

My children call across the hills,
I hear them in the wind.
I'll keep them whole, I'll keep them fed
So the warrior goes marching on.

(Chorus)

Verse 3:

When steel meets steel, I'll see her face,
When blood runs hot, her name.
I swore to find her, life or death
So the warrior goes marching on.

Final Chorus (slower, heavier):

March on, march on, the sun still burns,
March on, march on, till I return.

This soldier, this husband, this hollow man
So the warrior goes marching on.

Performance Notes

Performed at 74 BPM a slow, deliberate pace that lets soldiers pound shields or stomp in unison. Opens with a single war horn, blown low and long, signaling the army to silence before the first verse. War drums carry the rhythm throughout, their deep boom marking each beat across thousands of voices. The drums never stop from first verse through final chorus, symbolizing the warrior who keeps marching regardless of grief. During chorus sections, the drums intensify with a double-hit on “march on, march on,” giving soldiers a natural point to strike shields or stamp feet.

In formal ceremonies at Haleker, a bowed low-string instrument joins the drums, playing a single sustained note beneath each verse that swells during the final chorus. The low-string instrument is never used on the battlefield, only at funerals, victory feasts, and the annual remembrance of Pataryi’s death. The song ends as it begins: the drums fall silent, and the war horn sounds once more, holding its note until breath runs out.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

Military dominance (ranked #1 in Aicruae), commanding two exclusive military organizations, war victories across centuries, fierce warriors bred from childhood, self-preservation instincts, wealth, trade influence, and the defining ethos: “We protect what’s ours, at all costs.”

What They Lack

Social acceptance, trust from other houses, internal family stability.

Vulnerabilities

A history of mental illness running through the bloodline, isolation from other noble houses, internal family dysfunction, and the ever-present risk of their own members turning volatile.

Role in Narrative

Book Appearances: Book 1 (A Tale of a Thousand Songs) primarily through Queen Mihai Julie and her children Iris and Orcus.

Plot Significance: House Vika's power and the marriage alliance to House Patton is a root cause of the civil war. The breakdown of the Benjamin-Mihai marriage and Benjamin's preference for Solis over the Vika-blooded twins triggers the conflict that reshapes Aicruae.

Key Members in Story: Queen Mihai Julie Patton (deceased before the main story, but heavily referenced), Princess Iris Aleka Patton (Vika blood, major antagonist), and Prince Orcus Emere Patton (Vika blood, major antagonist).

Cross-References

House Patton, House Vemer, House Leva, House Arvento, House Aedria, House Hige, King Darien Lacern Patton, King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II, Queen Mihai Julie Patton, Princess Iris Aleka Patton, Prince Orcus Emere Patton, Emperor Solis Elias Patton, Lady Emillea Hige, Eastern Aicruae, Town of Haleker, City of Rewqo, Battle of Rewqo, Battle of Summers, Battle of Little Hill, Battle of Bears, Battle of Rivers Point, Battle of GreyNest, Bloody Winter, Siege of High Water, Aicruan Civil War, The Ivera's, Swords of Mertyeria, Code of Rose (House Vemer Alliance), Joyless Death (Poison), Nerai (Plant), "So the Warrior Goes Marching On" (Battle Song), Rillic (Religion), Nellebrie (Temple/Burial Site), Divine Faction, A Tale of a Thousand Songs (Book 1), Fox Maneuver / Great Ambush (Battle Strategy), Sunset Hour, Council of the Forsaken (House Aedria Connection)

Keywords

House Vika, Vika, Duke, Duchess, Eastern Aicruae, Haleker, The Gods Chosen Warrior, Divine Faction, The Truth Shall Prevail Above All Lies, Wild Boar, Dark Purple, Lavender, Rillic, Team, Lorde, The Ivera's, Swords of Mertyeria, Rern, Pokuerya Vika, Mihadlen Agasetire, Axiker Vika, Belia Vika, Dreskien Vika, Ceva Vika, Ceva the Mad, Raimaeo Vika, Xavien Vika, Eseraen Vika, Jeneo Vika, Lord of Thousand Years, Pataryi, So the Warrior Goes Marching On, Sekid Vika, Great Warrior of Haleker, Fox Maneuver, Great Ambush, Dexona Vika, Champion of Little Hill, Aintana Vika, Jewel of House Vika, Winter Rose, Hasken Vemer, Ualvo Vemer,

Code of Rose, Ooya Vika I, Ooya Vika II, Iayeta Vika, Wasler, Yarsi Vika, Joyless Death, Nerai, Tacah, Foolish Daughter, Vono Vika, Bloody Prince of the Damned Vika, Vasernio Vika, Ashara, Siege of High Water, Duke Rarielo Vika, Lemalen Vika, Gaceqi Vika, Beazen Vika, Mihai Julie Vika, The Vika Queen, King Benjamin II, Lady Emillea Hige, Iris Aleka Patton, The Damned, Lady of Sorrow, Orcus Emere Patton, The Unlawful, Battle of Rewqo, Nellebrie, Emperor Solis, Sunset Hour, Battle of Summers, Battle of Little Hill, Battle of Bears, Bloody Winter, Battle of Rivers Point, Battle of GreyNest, Eradicated, Poison Immunity, Trials of the Name, House Patton, House Vemer, House Leva, House Arvento, House Aedria, Mental Illness, Civil War, A Tale of a Thousand Songs